AEXIS: The Americas AI Exchange

IA, Desarrollo Económico y Buena Gobernanza

Adaptability as a central AI strategy

Paul Wayland

AI Solutions Initiative



State of the Island
: Economic Frailty

November 2026

Real GNP Growth

2026: 0.3% *estimated

2027: 0.2% *projected

PR Department of Economic Development and Commerce, 2026

Base level GNP 2014

2024: **(4.4%)**

grew from 2021-2024

US Government Accountability Office, 2025

Employment: **(0.8%)**

weekly wages: **$724** - PR; **$1,654** - USA

San Juan: **26%** of PR; **(3.0%)**

US Bureau of Labor Statistics, 2026

Outlook: **stagnant**, uncertain

favorable indicators: **2/17**

AI ≠ ECONOMIC STRATEGY

State of the Private Sector
: Weak Diffusion

November 2026

GDP includes significant amount of exports generated by intellectual property-intensive industries, particularly by pharmaceutical manufacturers, medical and scientific equipment manufacturers, and computer service providers.

US Bureau of Economic Analysis, 2026

How much knowledge, wage income, local procurement, entrepreneurship, and decision capacity remains in Puerto Rico?

11.7% of PR Business using AI

US Census Bureau, 2026

SMEs face persistent barriers in cost, infrastructure, data, and skills, and unassisted diffusion can widen existing productivity gaps between large and small firms.

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, 2025

agentic commerce could become a **$3-$5 trillion** global market by 2030

organizational + skills > technology

purchasing a capable model is *easier* than redesigning a firm around it

Rivera, 2026

TECHNOLOGY-EXTENSION MODEL

State of AI
: AI Capability outpacing productivity

November 2026

advancing fast: coding, mathematics, science, multimodal reasoning, computer use

performance remains “jagged”

agents still fail many apparently simple or real-world tasks

Stanford Institute for Human-Centered AI, 2026

improve faster than experts anticipate

uncertainty through 2030 substantial

could slow due to bottlenecks

continue; or accelerate: ***AI fuels AI research***

International AI Safety Report 2026

utilization-adjusted total factor productivity
April 2025 to March 2026 = 0.07%

95% of AI-related productivity statements concerned future rather than realized gains

Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, 2026

State of Governance
: Incomplete and Fragmented

November 2026

PRITS has an existing coordination and policy mandate for executive-branch information technology

Ley Núm. 75 de 25 de julio de 2019

adds cybersecurity responsibilities to PRITS

Ley Núm. 40 de 18 de enero de 2024

requires agencies and public corporations to disclose when citizens are interacting with automated or AI-assisted service channels and guarantees a route to human assistance

Ley Núm. 116 del año 2026

adds AI use to
government cybersecurity education

Ley Núm. 140 del año 2026

establishes disclosure requirements for political communications

generated wholly or partly with AI

Ley Núm. 105 del año 2026

broader proposals pending/vetoed

including proposals for a government AI officer and council, an AI institute, and more explicit government-wide AI authority

PRITS's oversight adequate in some areas deficient or only moderate in network security, vulnerability management, disaster recovery, and system interconnection

PR Office of the Inspector General, 2025

State of Education
: Central Adaptation Structure

November 2026

AI-aware educational processes

reassessment of what students should learn

human community + hands-on learning

reflection, iteration, and improvement

education adapts as AI changes

MIT Office of the President, 2026

- faculty development and curriculum transformation
- governed administrative workflow pilots with human review and measured results
- student workshops, stackable credentials, portfolios, and work experience

Education should prepare students for *transitions*, **not** a *job description*

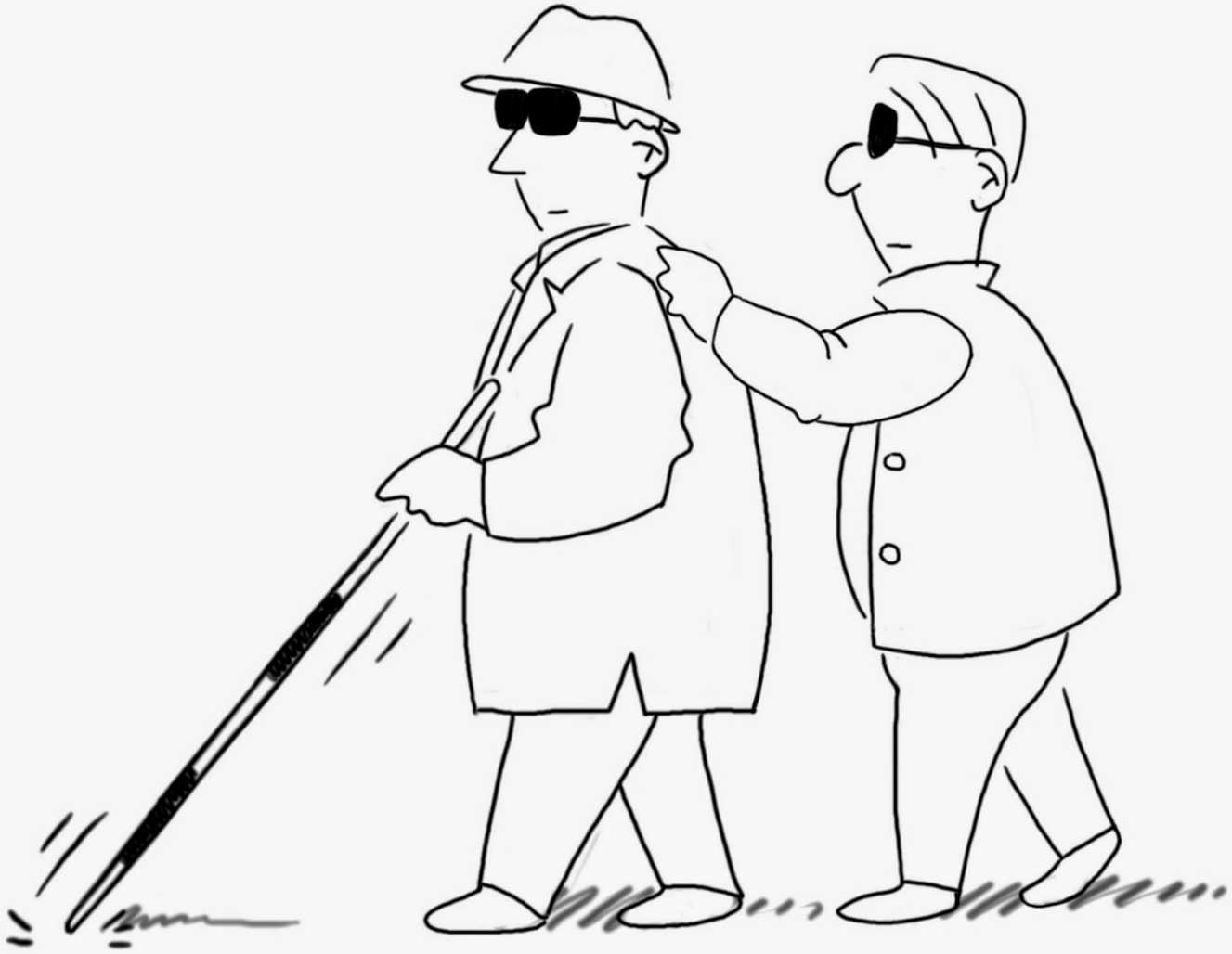
AI Trajectories

: advances broadly as expected

: development stalls

: advances beyond expectations

2027-2031



adaptive state ≠ AI buy program

: Preparedness and Productivity Council

: Build digital foundations

: Govern by risk and consequence

: Tie procurement to outcomes

: Extend workflow to SMEs + municipalities

: Prepare transition mechanisms before a shock

redesign work and share gains

: Begin with the bottleneck, not the model

: Measure the whole system

: Involve workers in design

: Build portability and resilience

: Build Puerto Rican value chains

prepare to adapt, judge, and create

: Teach AI across disciplines, not just CS

: Protect the foundations that make AI useful

: Make learning visible

: Treat faculty and staff capacity as infrastructure

: Make universities regional learning partners

Questions?
Suggestions?
Please?



https://github.com/pwayland/lab317-open-resources

pwayland@intermetro.edu

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